

   A PHARMA CASE STUDY

Lupin Limited

From ₹5,000 Borrowed From His Wife to a Global Pharma Powerhouse

How an Indian generics maker turned a 2019 quality crisis into a complex-generics and biosimilars growth story — told in five slides.

FOUNDED

1968, Mumbai

FY25 REVENUE

₹227 Bn (~\$2.7B)

MARKETS

100+ countries

Who Is Lupin?



The Origin Story

In 1968, chemistry professor Dr. Desh Bandhu Gupta borrowed ₹5,000 from his wife to start a small Mumbai venture making folic acid and iron tablets for a government maternal-health program. It grew into one of the world's largest anti-TB drug makers — and today, a transnational pharma leader.



11 countries

6 continents, 100+ markets



15 facilities

manufacturing plants in India



20,000+

employees worldwide



~\$10 Bn

market capitalization



Where Lupin Plays



Respiratory



Cardiovascular



Diabetes



Anti-Infectives



CNS



Paediatrics



Gastro-Intestinal



Gynaecology



Biosimilars

⚠️ When Growth Met Turbulence



The 2019 Compliance Crisis

- In March 2019, the U.S. FDA flagged quality and data-integrity concerns at several Lupin manufacturing plants, warning it might withhold approval of new drug applications from those sites.
- The timing stung: the U.S. was (and remains) Lupin's single largest market, generating roughly a third of global sales — so any slowdown in approvals hit the business where it mattered most.
- At the same time, commodity generic-drug pricing in the U.S. was under sustained pressure, squeezing margins on Lupin's traditional bread-and-butter portfolio.



What Was at Stake

~36%

of global sales rode on the U.S. market alone

Multiple

manufacturing sites placed under U.S. FDA scrutiny

The Turnaround Playbook



Fix the Foundation

A company-wide compliance and quality overhaul across manufacturing sites — remediating the exact plants the U.S. FDA had flagged.



Climb the Value Chain

A deliberate pivot from commodity generics toward complex generics, inhalation/respiratory products, and biosimilars — harder to copy, better margins.



Reinvest in Science

R&D spend held at roughly 8% of sales (₹17.7 Bn in FY25) across two research centers, fueling the next wave of approvals.



File, File, File

An aggressive ANDA filing pace with the U.S. FDA — 441 cumulative filings and 340 approvals by March 2025 — to refill the pipeline fast.

Results That Followed the Reset



+13.5%

FY25 revenue growth, to ₹227 Bn



+70.8%

jump in FY25 net profit



40%

of U.S. revenue now complex generics



340 / 441

ANDAs approved of those filed with the
FDA

 *Lupin is now the 8th largest company in the Indian Pharmaceutical Market (IQVIA, Mar 2025) and among the world's top 11 generics makers.*

What's Next

The next chapter leans further into biosimilars, specialty respiratory brands, and complex injectables — the same instinct that turned a ₹5,000 loan into a multi-billion-dollar pharma story: go where the science is hardest to copy.